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Corporate Exécutif Chef*

With the development and growth of international tourism, conglomerates of hotel chains, resorts, and restaurants are multiplying at a rapid rate. The corporate chef plays a role as an adviser, but most importantly supervises several establishments to maintain quality control. The corporate chef evaluates the staff and their technical results by observing the mise en place and encouraging continuing education for the chefs in each kitchen.

Continuing education today is an important aspect businesses should take into consideration for their long-term success. Establishment of a continuing education program recognizes motivated and loyal employees by sending them to do a "stage" in a top kitchen or attend a short specialization course, which allows the employees to perfect or learn new skills that will help their own kitchens evolve.

The corporate chef tests chefs' technical abilities and attitudes to determine whether their aptitudes correspond to the needs of the operation. The corporate chef is also responsible for creating the menus that will be used in the various outlets for which he or she is responsible.

This position requires a consummate professional, someone with considerable experience (technical and personnel management) who is willing to travel extensively and who is responsible for the financial and culinary direction of the operations.

Executive Chef* – *Directeur de Cuisine*

The title of executive chef is fairly new and did not exist during the time of Escoffier. You'll find this title used more often in North America than in Europe. Restaurants have become big business; as a result, chefs for larger kitchens require substantially greater business and management abilities. An executive chef in a large hotel kitchen often attends business meetings, deals with the human resources department, and crunches numbers on the computer.

Today, the executive chef is rarely found in the kitchen cooking, with the exception of managing special events, creating new menus, training for competitions, or preparing for promotions. The executive chef has become a manager and organizer who is financially accountable to the owner(s) or manager(s). The executive chef is also often asked to provide business advice, which requires an understanding of marketing and public relations in order to maximize sales. Ducasse, Bocuse, and even Escoffier were natural marketers.

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